Yujie Zhang

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Research Field and Topics

Development Economics, Applied Economics; Environment, Education, Health

Position

Postdoctoral Fellow, Population Studies Center, University of Pennsylvania *Aug 2025 - present*

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Houston *Texas, US, 2020 - 2025*
M.A. in Economics and Finance, Hanyang University *Seoul, Korea, 2016 - 2018*
B.E. in Ocean and Naval Engineering, Tianjin University *Tianjin, China, 2012 - 2016*

Working Papers

"The Long-Term Human Capital Consequences of Natural Disasters: Evidence from India" *[Draft] [Slides] [Poster]*

"Are Natural Disasters Disastrous for Learning? Evidence from Seven Asian Countries", with Jere R. Behrman, Emily Hannum, Minhaj Mahmud, and Fan Wang, ***Revise & Resubmit, Economics of Education Review****, Jul 2026 [ADBI Working Paper] [Slides]*

"Heat Stress, Air Pollution Risk, and Population Exposure: Evidence from Selected Asian Countries", with Minhaj Mahmud *[ADB Economics Working Paper Series] [Slides]*

Work in Progress

"Air Pollution, Socio-environmental Factors and Health of Children Under Age 5 in Asia", with Jere R. Behrman, Emily Hannum, and Minhaj Mahmud

"The Effect of Children Gender on Younger Siblings' Health Outcomes"

Publications

Behrer, A. Patrick, R. Jisung Park, and Yujie Zhang. 2026. "Climate Change and Human Capital." In *Handbook of the Economics of Climate Change Volume 2*, edited by Lint Barrage and Solomon Hsiang, 2:385456. Handbook of the Economics of Climate Change. North-Holland, January. *[Journal link]*

Zhang, Yujie, and Deokwoo Nam. 2022. "News-Driven Business Cycles: Evidence from Investors Expectations of Future Stock Market Returns." *Journal of Economic Research* 27, no. 1 (May): 122. *[Journal link]*

Research Experience

Consultant, Asian Development Bank *Jul 2024 - present*

Project: Strengthening policies on climate change in Asia and the Pacific

Doctorate Researcher, PIRE Project funded by NSF *Jan 2023 - Apr 2025*

Project: Climate risk, pollution, and childhood inequalities in low- and middle-income countries

Graduate Researcher, Institute for Research on Women, Gender and Sexuality *Jun 2022 - Jun 2023*

Census Household Pulse Survey Analysis; LGBTQ+ Support Project with Montrose Center

Research Assistant, Elaine M. Liu, University of Houston *Feb 2022*

Analyzed county-level data on car accident mortality using FARS and NHIS.

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Econometric Methods And Models, University of Pennsylvania *Fall 2025 - Spring 2027*

[Evaluation]; *[Syllabus]*; 120+ enrolled

Lecturer, Principles of Microeconomics, University of Houston *Spring 2024*

[Evaluation]: 4.1/5 for "Overall course quality"; 4.6/5 for "Respect students"; *[Syllabus]*; 80+ enrolled

Lecturer, **Ph.D. Math Camp**, University of Houston *2021 - 2023*

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics I **(Ph.D.)**, Nathan J. Canen, University of Houston *Spring 2022*

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics I **(Ph.D.)**, Janet E. Kohlhase, University of Houston *Fall 2021*

Evaluation: 5/5 for "Teaching assistant was receptive to questions"; 4.9/5 for "Teaching assistant was available for assistance to students" (department average: 4/5).

Teaching Assistant, Eleanor Jawon Choi, Hanyang University *Mar 2017 - Jul 2018*

Applied Econometrics **(Graduate)**, Introductory Mathematical Economics, Econometrics, Empirical Methods in Applied Microeconomics; 150+ students each semester.

Working Experience

Client Manager, Bank of Communications *Jiangsu, China, Aug 2018 - Sep 2019*

Served as vice organizer for the Suzhou Gusu branch in "Best Service Bank Branch" national competition, achieving "Four-Star" award from the China Banking Association.

Professional Activities

Coordinator, UH Econ Student Brown Bag Seminar, University of Houston *2023 - 2024*

Referee *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Economics of Education Review, Environmental and Resource Economics, Economic Modelling, PLOS One, Population and Environment*

Discussant Asian Economic Development Conference 2024; ADBI Conference on Increasing Resilience of Education Systems in Asia and the Pacific

Presentations

** coauthor presentation*

2026 ADB Economists Forum*

2025 ADB Economists Forum (Philippines); PAA (US); MR2025 Columbia Climate School (US)

2024 CIES*; PAA (US); AMES (China); Asian Economic Development Conference (Korea); STATA Texas Empirical Microeconomics Conference (US); SEA (US); AASLE (Thailand)

2023 PDRI-DevLab Workshop (virtual); ADBI Conference on Increasing Resilience of Education Systems in Asia and the Pacific (Japan); Penn-Houston Climate, Environment, and Child Development Workshop (US); SWUFE SoE Workshop (China)

Awards and Fellowships

Cullen Graduate Fellowship Travel Grant, University of Houston *Apr 2024*
Graduate Fellowship, University of Houston *Sep 2020 - May 2025*
Teaching Assistantship, Hanyang University *Mar 2017 - Jul 2018*
TOPIK Scholarship, Hanyang University *Dec 2017, Mar 2018*

Skills

Languages Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Korean (TOPIK-5)
Computer Python, Stata, LaTeX, R, Matlab

References

Jere R. Behrman, William R. Kenan, Jr. Professor of Economics, University of Pennsylvania
behrman@econ.upenn.edu

Emily Hannum, Stanley I. Sheerr Term Professor in the Social Sciences, Associate Dean for Social Sciences, Professor of Sociology, University of Pennsylvania
hannumem@sas.upenn.edu

Minhaj Mahmud, Senior Economist, Economic Research and Development Impact Department, Asian Development Bank
mmahmud@adb.org

Elaine M. Liu, Bernard B. and Eugenia A. Ramsey Chair and Professor of Economics at Andrew Young School of Policy Studies, Faculty Director of Georgia Policy Labs, Georgia State University
emliu@uh.edu

Fan Wang, Associate Professor of Economics, University of Houston
fwang26@uh.edu